Activity 4: Data Breach Notification Tabletop

Mapping: K1, A1 / LO1

Duration: 20 minutes

Deliverable: Incident decision log, notification outline and remediation list.

Goal

Practise containment, assessment, decision ownership, notification timing and evidence capture under the PDPA breach-notification framework.

Real Case Study

Case: SESAMi (Singapore) Pte Ltd and Abecha Pte Ltd - shared B2B e-commerce ransomware incident

Date: 26 February 2026

Status: PDPC breach decision and directions

Official source: PDPC - Breach of the Protection Obligation by SESAMi and Abecha

Published Facts

PDPC published a decision concerning a ransomware incident affecting SESAMi and Abecha on a shared B2B e-commerce network. About 39,000 individuals were affected and bank and credit-card details were among the data rendered inaccessible. PDPC identified unpatched systems, weak access controls and failure to enforce multi-factor authentication, found a breach of the Protection Obligation, and issued directions to strengthen security.

Exercise Boundary

The published materials do not supply every incident-response timestamp needed for this classroom tabletop. Learners must mark scenario assumptions as assumptions and must not present invented timestamps as case facts.

Questions

1. What containment and evidence-preservation actions should begin first?
2. Which published facts affect significant-harm or significant-scale assessment?
3. Which missing timestamps are needed to apply the three-calendar-day rule?
4. What should the decision log show even when the public summary is silent?

Detailed Step-by-Step

1. Assign incident roles: coordinator, technical lead, DPO/legal, communications and executive sponsor.
2. List immediate containment actions without assuming deletion is proven.
3. Build a fact log separating known, unknown and evidence required.
4. Apply the notifiability test and document the decision owner.
5. Draft a six-line PDPC notification outline and an affected-person message outline.

6. Record remediation and vendor-control improvements for the post-incident review.

Worksheet

Requirement / issue	Business fact	Gap or impact	Decision / control	Owner	Deadline	Evidence

Acceptance Check

- ■ Containment precedes notification drafting
- ■ Clock described accurately
- ■ Known/unknown facts separated
- ■ Decision and evidence documented

Debrief

- What assumption had the greatest effect on your recommendation?
- What evidence would a director, auditor or regulator expect to see?
- What would you verify with qualified legal, tax or sector advice?

Sources

- PDPC - Breach of the Protection Obligation by SESAMi and Abecha
- PDPC - Required to notify the PDPC

Educational activity only; verify current requirements with the relevant regulator and qualified advisers.

Real-Life Case Brief: SESAMi and Abecha Ransomware Incident

Regulator: Personal Data Protection Commission (PDPC)

Published: 26 February 2026

Procedural status: Breach decision and directions

Verified: 12 August 2026

Regulator-Published Facts

- A ransomware incident affected SESAMi (Singapore) Pte Ltd and Abecha Pte Ltd on a shared B2B e-commerce network.
- About 39,000 individuals were affected; bank and credit-card details were among data rendered inaccessible.
- PDPC identified unpatched systems, weak access controls and failure to enforce multi-factor authentication.
- PDPC found a breach of the Protection Obligation and issued directions to strengthen security.

Classroom Boundary

The tabletop adds missing timestamps only as labelled scenario assumptions. Learners must not claim those invented timestamps describe the actual incident.

Official Evidence

PDPC - Breach of the Protection Obligation by SESAMi and Abecha

Completion Checklist: Data Breach Tabletop

- Open an incident fact log with known, unknown and assumed fields.
- Preserve logs, images, access records and the decision chronology.
- Contain access without destroying forensic evidence.
- Assess significant harm and significant scale against current PDPC guidance.
- Record when the organisation first had credible grounds to believe a breach occurred.
- Name the notifiability decision owner and evidence reviewed.
- Draft PDPC and affected-person communications without unsupported certainty.
- Label every classroom timestamp or fact not published by PDPC as an assumption.